
Wire — Administration Guide

Running the clock, the doorway, and the repository,
without a command line

Wire v0.17.54 · repository **willyros01/balita** · September 23,
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Overview

Wire runs itself. Nobody has to open a laptop or press a button for the news to update — three separate pieces hand work to each other on a schedule, each one doing a single job. This guide is organised around those three pieces, in the order a new administrator would actually meet them.

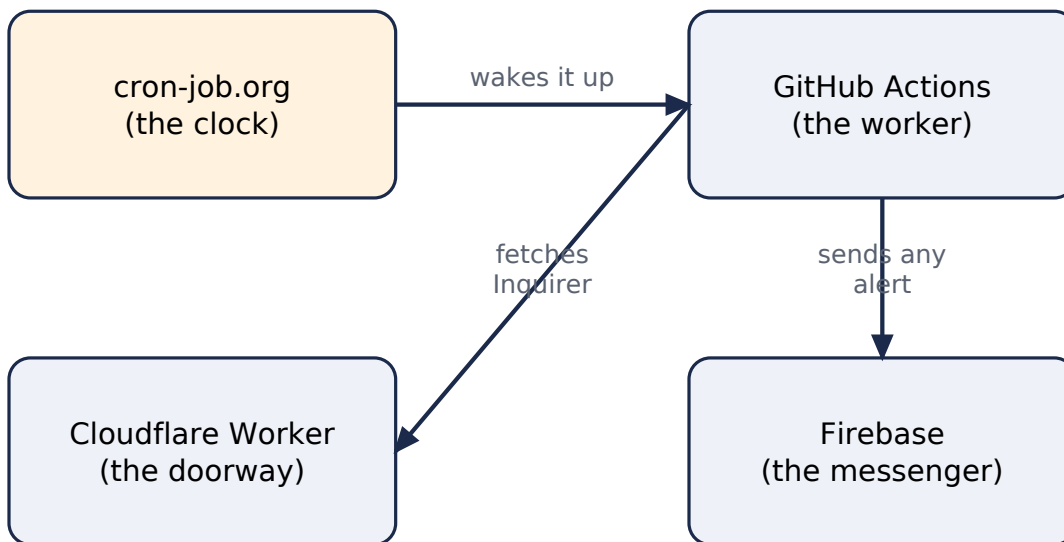


Figure 1. The three pieces an administrator manages, and what each hands to the next.

Piece	What it owns	Where you manage it
The clock	Starts a run every 30 minutes, reliably	cron-job.org
The worker	Fetches every feed, writes articles.json, decides on alerts	github.com — Actions tab
The doorway	Fetches the three Inquirer feeds specifically, since they block GitHub's own servers	dash.cloudflare.com
The messenger	Delivers a breaking-news alert to subscribed phones	Firebase Console (rarely touched directly)

Section A — The Clock (cron-job.org)

Without this piece, Wire only updates when someone manually presses **Run workflow**. This is what makes it happen on its own, every half hour, forever.

A.1 — What it actually does

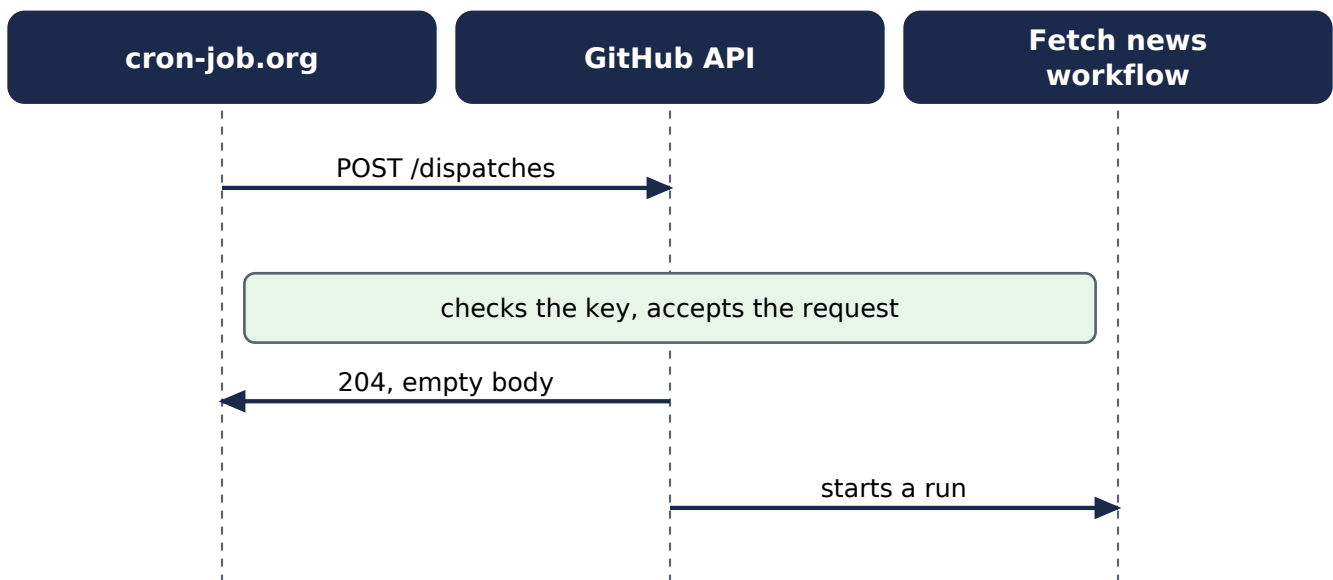


Figure 2. One tick of the clock. The empty 204 reply is success, not a fault — it means "understood, nothing more to say."

A.2 — Making the key (once)

A key proves a request genuinely comes from you. Made on your own GitHub account, restricted to this one repository, and given exactly one permission.

1. Sign in at **github.com**, tap your picture top right, then **Settings**.
2. Scroll to the very bottom of the left sidebar → **Developer settings**.

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3. **Personal access tokens** → **Fine-grained tokens** → **Generate new token**.
 4. Name it **wire-scheduler**. Set expiration to 1 year.
 5. Under **Repository access**, choose **Only select repositories** and pick **balita**.
 6. Under **Repository permissions**, find **Contents** and change it to **Read and write**. Nothing else.
 7. **Generate token**, then **copy it immediately** — it is shown once only.

Why only Contents

This key can touch one repository and change only its files. It cannot see your other repositories, your account settings, or anything beyond balita's own content.

A.3 — Setting up the job

1. At **cron-job.org**, sign up, confirm the email, then **Create cronjob**.
2. Title: **Wire news**.
3. URL: **`https://api.github.com/repos/YOUR-USERNAME/balita/dispatches`**
4. Schedule: **every 30 minutes**, at minutes **7** and **37** if offered — the exact half hour is when every other free job on the service fires at once.
5. Open **Advanced**. Change the method from GET to **POST**.
6. In the request body box, paste exactly:
`{"event_type":"fetch-news"}`

7. Add four headers, exactly as below, then **Create**.

Header	Value
Accept	application/vnd.github+json
Content-Type	application/json
Authorization	Bearer github_pat_... (your key from A.2, with the word Bearer and one space in front)
X-GitHub-API-Version	2022-11-28

A.4 — Testing it

On the job's page, tap **Test run**. Then check the responses below.

Response	Meaning	What to do
204	Success	Open the Actions tab — a new run should already be starting.
401	Key rejected	Check for the word “Bearer” and one space before the key.
404	Not found, or no permission	Re-check the URL for a typo, then re-check A.2 step 6.
403	Key expired or deleted	Make a new key, repeat A.2.
422	Malformed message	The body must be exactly {"event_type":"fetch-news"}
200 with a page of text	It sent GET, not POST	Revisit the Advanced method setting.

Ongoing maintenance

Nothing to do month to month. Once a year the key expires; cron-job.org emails a warning. Repeat A.2 for a fresh key and paste it into the Authorization header.

Section B — The Doorway (Cloudflare Worker)

Three Inquirer feeds — Inquirer News, and the article pages behind all three Inquirer properties — refuse requests from GitHub's own servers outright, while happily answering a request from Cloudflare's network. This piece exists purely to route around that one specific block. It is not used by, or visible to, anyone reading the app.

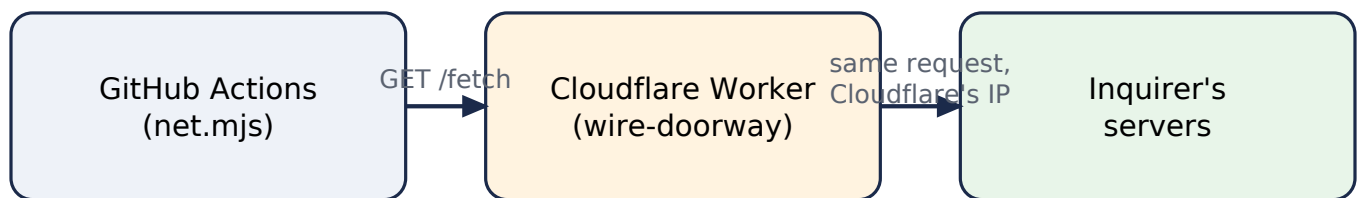


Figure 3. GitHub asks the Worker to fetch on its behalf; Inquirer only ever sees Cloudflare's own address.

B.1 — The shared password

One password, written in two places, is what lets the two ends recognise each other. Invent a long phrase — it never needs to be typed by a person again after this setup.

1. In Cloudflare: **Workers & Pages** → **wire-doorway** → **Settings** → **Variables and Secrets**.
2. Add a **Secret** (not a plain Text variable) named **WIRE_KEY**, value = your password. Save and deploy.

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3. In GitHub: repository **Settings** → **Secrets and variables** → **Actions** → **New repository secret**.
 4. Add **WIRE_KEY** with the exact same password, and **WIRE_DOOR_URL** with the plain worker address (no trailing slash, no /fetch).

B.2 — The routed hosts

Both the Worker's own allow-list and net.mjs's THROUGH_THE_DOOR set must name the same nine hosts. Adding a new one later means editing both, or it will not route.

```
newsinfo.inquirer.net www.inquirer.net globalnation.inquirer.net  
business.inquirer.net sports.inquirer.net entertainment.inquirer.net  
technology.inquirer.net lifestyle.inquirer.net cebudailynews.inquirer.net
```

Manila Bulletin is deliberately NOT routed here

Being on an allow-list only means the Worker will try. It does not make the far side accept the request — Manila Bulletin refuses Cloudflare too, with its own challenge page, so routing it through here would not help and risks the app mistaking that challenge page for a real feed.

B.3 — Testing it

Run **Actions** → **Fetch news** → **Run workflow**, then read the log.

Before (not working)	After (working)
Inquirer News 40 stories (summary only 40)	Inquirer News 40 stories (page 40)

“page 40” means the doorway succeeded and those stories now carry full text, not just headlines.

B.4 — Troubleshooting

Log says	Meaning	Fix
No doorway configured	GitHub can't see the secrets	Re-check both secret names in B.1 — case-sensitive
inqn — HTTP 401	The two passwords differ	Compare Cloudflare's and GitHub's value character-for-character
inqn — HTTP 403	The Worker itself refused the host	Confirm the host is in the Worker's own ALLOWED list
doorway circuit open after repeated HTTP 403	Inquirer refused the Worker twice this run	Normal and self-healing — the feed copy is kept, and it tries again next run

Section C — Wire Repository Admin Tasks

C.1 — Uploading a code change

Every file Wire is built from lives at the root of the **balita** repository on GitHub, edited directly from Safari.

1. Open the file on github.com, tap the pencil icon to edit.
2. Select all existing content, delete it, paste in the replacement.
3. Scroll down, add a short commit message, tap **Commit changes**.
4. For several files at once: **Add file → Upload files**, drag them all in, one commit.

This auto-triggers a run

sw.js, app.js, version.js, sources.json, breaking-notify.mjs and several other files are watched by the workflow itself — committing any of them starts a real Fetch news run within moments, with no button to press.

C.2 — Running things by hand

Task	Where
Force an immediate fetch	Actions → Fetch news → Run workflow
Send one real test alert	Same screen — tick “Send one clearly labelled test alert” before running
Roll back application code only	Actions → Roll back application code → Run workflow

The rollback workflow always previews first (**dry_run** defaults to true). Run it once to read what it would change, then run it again with `dry_run` set to false to actually commit.

C.3 — Reading an Actions log

Open the run, then the single job inside it. The fetcher prints, per source: how many stories were in the feed, how many were already known, and how many needed fetching — followed by a second pass showing what each source actually came away with, including how many carry a photo.

```
Inquirer News 40 in feed, 0 already had, 40 to fetch
```

```
...
```

```
Inquirer News 79 stories (page 79, feed 0, summary only 0, reused 0)
79/79 with a photo
```

C.4 — Notifications admin

Task	Where
Turn alerts on/off for one device	Inside Wire itself — Sources screen → Turn on / Turn off
See who is subscribed	Firebase Console → Firestore → pushSubscriptions collection
Stop all alerts instantly	Disable the Fetch news workflow, or remove the sender's FCM role in Google Cloud IAM

Approved markers

An alert only ever sends for a headline a publisher has themselves tagged: Breaking:, Just In:, Urgent:, Live: (or the same in square brackets), from one of eight approved sources. Nothing is inferred from subject matter.

Section D — Emergency Stop & Full Reference

D.1 — To pause each piece

Piece	Pause	Stop entirely
The clock	Switch the job off at cron-job.org	Delete the GitHub token — revokes access instantly
The doorway	—	Delete the two GitHub secrets; Inquirer falls back to headline-only
Alerts	Turn off in Wire, per device	Disable the Fetch news workflow entirely

D.2 — Every secret this project uses

Name	Held where	Used for
WIRE_KEY	GitHub secret + Cloudflare secret (must match)	Authenticating GitHub to the doorway
WIRE_DOOR_URL	GitHub secret	The doorway's own address
cron-job.org's own key	GitHub fine-grained PAT, entered into cron-job.org only	Starting a scheduled run
Google Workload Identity	google-github-actions/auth in feeds.yml	Lets Actions get a short-lived Google token — no stored key at all
Firebase web config + VAPID key	config.js (public by design)	Lets a browser register for push — not a secret

Nothing above is ever committed to the repository as plaintext

Every credential lives in GitHub's or Cloudflare's own secret store, or is exchanged fresh at runtime through Google's Workload Identity Federation. The repository itself holds no long-lived key.